

Year 12 General English Student Workbook One



UNIT 3

Sections 1 & 2



Student Name: _____

1. Persuasive Techniques

The learning intentions for this unit of work are to:

1. Revise common persuasive techniques
2. Identify the tone of a passage or an image
3. Identify the style of a passage
4. Identify the main contention of an image or passage
5. Practise analysing persuasive techniques
6. Examine how persuasive techniques work together
7. Identify facts, opinions and supporting evidence

Persuasive techniques are deliberately chosen to influence and persuade viewers and readers. You will be asked to analyse how language is used to persuade and audience to share a particular viewpoint. Analysis of language is not just a matter of recognising examples in verbal or visual texts and listing them in your written or oral response. You will need to show how they actually work by explaining how they influence, persuade or position the audience.

Common Persuasive Techniques Table

The table below lists common techniques accompanied by examples. It also summarises, in general terms, how these techniques work to persuade an audience.

Technique	Example	Effect
Alliteration Repetition of a sound, particularly at the beginning of words. Often used in headlines.	'Fighting fat at just five' (Headline, Daily Telegraph, 12 January 2008)	• Captures attention • Adds emphasis to the writer's point • Draws attention to key words
Analogy Compares one thing or situation with another.	Self-regulation for chemical companies is like putting students in charge of marking their own exams.	• Explains a complex point in more familiar terms • Makes the contention look straightforward and obvious
Anecdotes A brief personal account or story.	A friend visiting from interstate was baffled by our train ticketing system. Rather than being helped, she received a fine for not having the correct ticket.	• Often entertaining or humorous • Personal angle engages the reader • As 'true stories' they carry weight with readers
Appeal to a sense of justice Speaks to people's belief	Mandatory detention of refugees is punishment for a crime they didn't commit, and an attack on the most vulnerable group in our society.	• Positions the reader to agree that the punishment should fit the crime • Arouses anger at a perceived injustice

Common Persuasive Techniques Table

Technique	Example	Effect
Appeal to being modern and up-to-date Based on people's desire to have the latest information and products and to belong to the in-crowd.	Finally, with the latest versions of iPhones or Blackberries, we can keep up with all of the latest issues, locally and globally, because we are connected with events as they happen.	• Positions the reader to feel that they would be left behind and less informed than those around them if they don't embrace new technology. • Makes people want to acquire the products, information or attitudes being discussed.
Appeal to family values Based on the belief that traditional family arrangements are the best foundation for individuals and society.	I blame the ease of divorce nowadays, which results in fractured and fatherless families, for the spiralling crime rate.	• Leads readers to view traditional families as the most desirable arrangement. • Positions the reader to feel that other arrangements
Appeal to fear Portrays worst-case scenarios as likely; emphasises the need to take preventative action.	With so many predators about, not to mention reckless drivers, it's a foolish parent who would allow their child to walk to school unaccompanied these days.	• Causes the reader to respond emotionally, especially with feelings of anxiety and unease. • Leads the reader to want to take action to protect themselves and their loved ones.
Appeal to group loyalty Uses the desire of people to belong to a group in order to persuade them to agree with a viewpoint or take action.	It was heart-warming to see so many in our community joining forces to prevent the new freeway destroying our town.	• Can play on people's guilt, sense of obligation, fear and sentimentality. • Convinces people that they should act to support the group.
Appeal to patriotism Draws on national pride and people's loyalty to their nation.	Our national flag has seen us through two world wars, social upheavals and the change of the millennium.	• Positions readers to feel that they would be disloyal to their country to disagree with the writer. • Arouses strong emotions of pride, guilt, loyalty; sometimes anger and fear.

Common Persuasive Techniques Table

Technique	Example	Effect
Appeal to self-interest Suggests that one's own interests should be placed ahead of others'.	The problems of the Aboriginal community are not my fault. I don't intend to be out of pocket when the compensation claims come rolling in.	- Often divides people into 'them' and 'us.' - Suggests that the interests of others are in competition with and threaten our own.
Appeal to the hip-pocket nerve Relates to people's concern about their financial wellbeing.	Another day, another tax hike for the ordinary taxpayer. What I want to know is, where is all this extra money going?	- Provokes strong emotions, such as outrage, at being taken advantage of. - Positions readers to feel threatened by those who want to raise prices etc.
Appeal to tradition and custom Places a high value on the past and one's heritage. Suggests that abandoning tradition is damaging to society.	His family have farmed the land for generations. But now drought relief payments are all that separate him from having to give up the only life he has ever known.	- Encourages the reader to resist change, and to feel that links with the past should be retained. - Sometimes romanticises the past and rejects modern ways of doing things.
Attacks Use to denigrate an opponent and, by implication, their point of view.	It is a bit rich for the Minister to be pontificating about family values considering the skeletons in his own closet.	- Draw attention away from reasoned argument. - Position the reader to agree that if an individual is flawed, their message must be too.
Cliches A familiar but overused expression that carries a range of associations.	If Jo Blow had been found with that amount of cocaine it would have been a jail sentence for sure. But it seems our sportspeople these days get away with murder.	- Convey meaning in an economical way - Can help readers feel more comfortable with an idea.
Connotations Associations or implied meanings of words.	Predictably, the feminazis pop up again, bleating about unfair treatment.	Arouses feelings and attitudes that position the reader to like/dislike, accept/reject a group, idea or viewpoint.

Common Persuasive Techniques Table

Technique	Example	Effect
Emotive language Strong words used to promote emotion in the reader.	I am absolutely disgusted at the travesty of justice apparent in the pathetic sentence given to such a vicious killer.	- Positions the reader to react emotionally, rather than rationally. - Leads the reader to share the writer's feelings on the subject.
Evidence Facts, information or expert opinions; often from an authoritative source. May be used selectively.	The CSRIO's extensive testing has found no or minimal risk associated with GM foods.	Gives the writer's argument more credibility as it is apparently objective and/or supported by experts.
Generalisation Involves the claim that if something is true of some people, it is true for all members of the group to which they belong.	Older drivers are the real menace on our roads. They're less alert, have slower reaction times and panic under pressure.	- Appeals to commonly held prejudices and attitudes. - Positions the reader to judge others according to stereotypes.
Inclusive language Involves the reader directly in the issue by using such words as 'we' or 'us.'	It's up to all of us to stand up to the multinational corporations whose rampant development is destroying our town.	- Makes the reader feel included and that their view counts. - Encourages the reader to agree since this view is apparently shared by the group as a whole.
Metaphors Comparisons that describe one thing in terms of another.	Love of money is a cancer that is eating away at our society.	- Capitalise on associations with a visual image - Evoke emotion in the reader which matches that of the writer.
Overstatement/exaggeration/hyperbole Using dramatic, forceful language to exaggerate the true situation.	It's a fight to the death between arch-enemies Collingwood and Carlton.	- Arouse emotion in the reader - Can be humorous 'worst-case scenario' play on readers' fears.
Puns Play on words that gives one word or phrase multiple meanings.	'Two-drink limit hard to swallow,' <i>Courier Mail</i> , 22 January, 2008.	- Often humorous - Gain the reader's attention and emphasises the writer's point - Uses connotations of words to convey writer's p.o.v.

Common Persuasive Techniques Table

Technique	Example	Effect
Reason and logic Invokes a clearly stated main contention and an argument that is supported by evidence or deduction; that is, by drawing a conclusion from something generally known or assumed to be 'true.'	If you choose to forfeit your right to participate in the democratic process by not voting, you forfeit all right to complain about the result.	• Gives the writer's viewpoint credibility for being apparently objective. • Can consider opposing viewpoints and argue logically against them.
Repetition Repeating words, phrases or ideas for emphasis.	House prices are up, fuel prices are up, grocery prices are up.	• Emphasises the writer's viewpoint and captures attention.
Rhetorical question A question that requires no answer usually because the answer is implied.	After the last fiasco, can the government really expect us to believe that they know what they're doing now?	• Positions the reader to agree by assuming their answer will be the same as the writer's. • Engages the reader by addressing them directly.

Tone

Tone is the mood or feeling of a piece of writing and reflects the writer's attitudes towards the subject matter. A helpful way of judging the tone of written text is to read it aloud – if read appropriately, the manner of reading should convey the tone.

WORDbank for tone

accusing	admonishing	aggressive	alarmist	angry
antagonistic	arrogant	assertive	authoritative	bemused
bitter	calm	concerned	condescending	cynical
disappointed	dismissive	guarded	mocking	optimistic
outraged	pleading	reasonable	respectful	restrained
sarcastic	shrill	sympathetic	terse	worried

Use Words for Tone

1. Select the words in the WORDbank and find their dictionary definitions.



Jensen, a six month-old wombat being cared for at the Warrandyte Wildlife Shelter. Published in the *Herald Sun*, 24 July 2009

2. How do you think the photographer or editor feels about the plight of this wombat? Select a word from the tone word bank: _____

**Pill-popping nation: \$250m of painkillers
And drugs to help nation cope**

Medicine cabinets are overflowing as
Australians pop a \$250 million cocktail of
Pain-killers and mind- altering drugs

Herald Sun 24 July 2009

3. How does the writer feel about the level of prescribed drugs in Australia? Select a word from the tone word bank above, or find another word that sums up the tone: _____

How tone persuades

A writer uses a particular tone in order to generate an emotional response and position the audience to share a point of view.

Example and analysis:

Genetic testing is a serious subject, one requiring sound advice and effective processes.

The writer uses a calm and serious tone in addressing the issue of genetic testing. By recognising the issue as 'serious' the audience is positioned to listen attentively. 'Sound advice' and 'effective processes' further

emphasise the seriousness of the issue, leading the audience to engage closely as they anticipate more information and reasons to support this viewpoint.

Analyse tone

Identify the tone used in the following sentence and explain how it positions the reader to agree:

I don't care what you say, why should we wear a uniform to school? I'm sick of wearing it. It's cold in winter, and hot in summer, and it's too expensive.

Style

Style refers to those features of written or spoken language relating to the form of expression rather than to the content of the text. Unlike tone, a particular style of writing does not convey emotion but is selected according to context and audience. For example, the style of a conversation between a game show host and a contestant would be **informal and chatty**. In contrast, an interview by the host of a current affairs program with a foreign head of state would be more **formal** with carefully prepared questions.

WORDbank for style

abrupt	flamboyant	measured
casual	fluent	sophisticated
clear	formal	straightforward
colloquial	informal	succinct
convoluted	literary	poetic
dignified	matter-of-fact	wordy

Use words for style

Select from the word bank on the previous page the style of expression that would be appropriate for:

1. A review of a recently released poetry anthology to be published in the Arts section of a daily broadsheet newspaper:

2. A blog about a community bike ride: -

3. A report on the human and property cost of last season's bushfires:

4. An opinion piece on reasons for increased poverty in a third-world country:

Main contention

The main contention states the central point or argument of a piece of text or speech. It:

- Reveals the point of view of the creator (writer, speaker, artist, photographer), and
- Often sets the tone of the piece – it may be authoritative or shocking, assertive or emotional.

The main contention is usually made clear from the outset: for example, in the opening sentence of a written piece or the first few remarks of a speech. However, in some text types, such as an opinion piece or editorial, the main contention might only be stated at or near the end.

Identify the main contention

Show that you can identify the main contention in the following examples by expressing it in your own words. Then state how the writer presents it.

Example	Main Contention (in your own words)	How main contention is presented
Alternative therapies for cancer patients should not be undertaken in preference to conventional treatments.	Cancer patients should not use alternative treatments instead of conventional ones.	The writer uses an assertive, confident tone that encourages readers to accept the writer's opinion.
Watch out MasterChef. Channels Nine and Seven are out to cook Ten's golden goose by launching their own knock-off cooking shows. 'Networks cook up a storm,' <i>Herald Sun</i> , 29 July, 2009.		

As a ruckman. Justin Madden was regarded as something of a dinosaur, a throwback to a bygone era. He is displaying the same qualities as the Planning Minister with his decision to permit the demolition of Lonsdale House. 'Losing our identity,' The Age, 2009.

Practice analysing persuasive techniques

This section gives you examples to help you practise analysing persuasive techniques. Each example contains notes on the way in which language is used to persuade.

Complete the sentences following each example to identify the main tone of each piece, the persuasive technique used and the intended effect of this technique on the reader.

Example 1

'Funky' has positive connotations

Funky Frankston fights back

Herald Sun 29 July 2009

'Fights back' suggests the Frankston community is standing up for itself

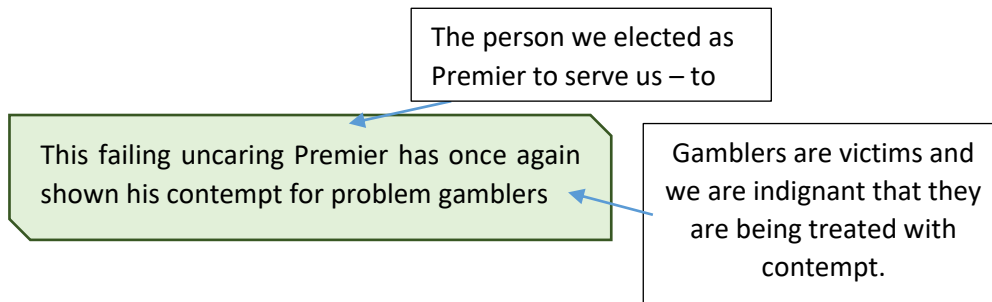
The sound of the letter 't' is quite forceful.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

Example 2

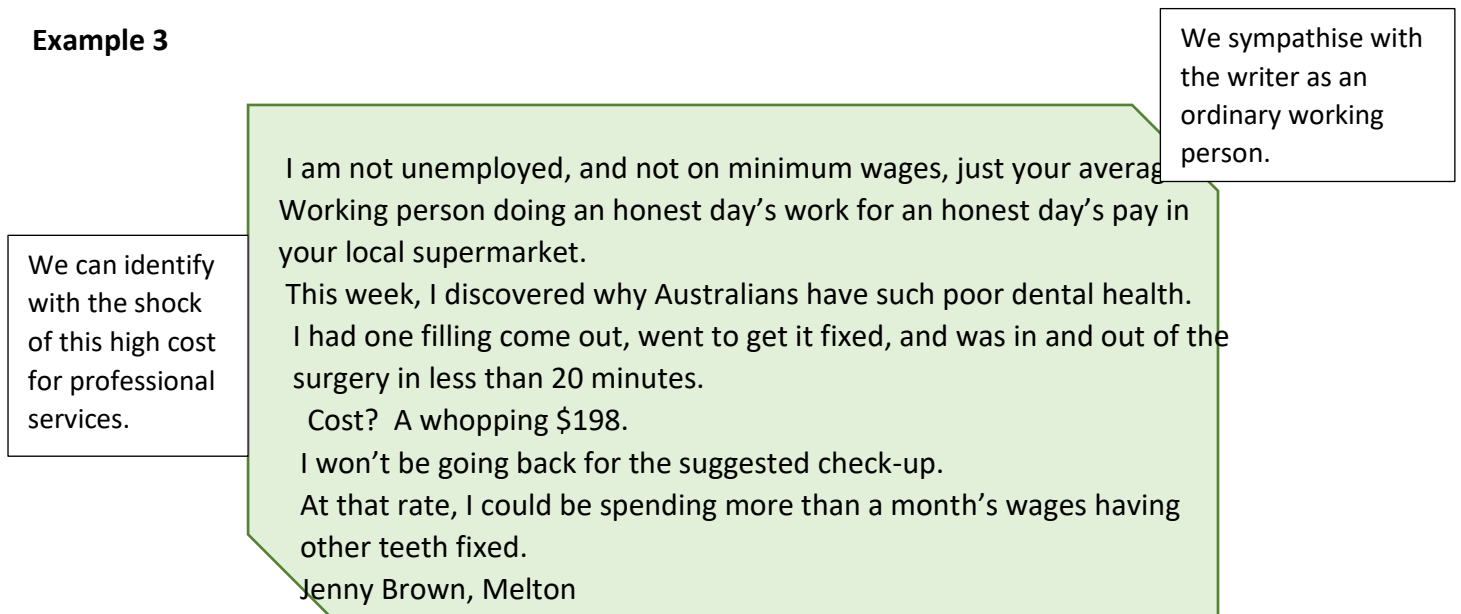


1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

Example 3



Herald Sun, 29 July 2009

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

Example 4

The following article appeared under a large colour photograph of a new red Ferrari:

Guess what? This is how you can pay for it!

Miss out on a chunky share of last night's \$15 million Super 7's Oz lotto jackpot? Not to worry. There is plenty more cash up for grabs this week.

It has been a lotto bonanza for punters for more than a month, with the nation's largest jackpot of \$106 million shared between just two tickets.

This week goes down in the record books for offering the most guaranteed first division prize winnings....

Herald Sun, 29 July 2009

The question in the headline directly addresses and engages the reader.

The answer to the question appeals to our desire to own such a car.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Which kinds of self-interest appeal most to teenagers? Select from the list below or think of your own examples.

academic success	appearance	fame	good job	happy family
hero status	physical strength	popularity	power	wealth

Example 5

The words 'disgusting' and 'appalling' encourage me to share the writer's outrage

It is disgusting that in this day and age we still tolerate such treatment of battery hens. I defy anyone to visit one of these barbaric 'farms' appalling and not be sickened by the cruel conditions under which these beautiful creatures are kept.

'Barbaric' and 'cruel' are strong words that make me feel the chickens are being tortured: makes me want to do something about it.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Suggest some emotive terms that could add 'colour' to the following:

- A local councillor who has used ratepayers' taxes to support his private business could be a

- A sporting hero who is constantly arrested for drunken brawling could be a

- A High Court judge who is charged with speeding but lies in court to avoid conviction could be a

- A cyclone that destroys the habitat of many endangered species could be a

Example 6

Poor start to the day

Stella Tzobanakis

One in four Australian children go to school without breakfast, according to a national study. *The Children's Nutrition and Physical Activity Study* by the University of Sydney found, on Average, 25 per cent of Australian students skipped breakfast.

Manningham Leader 29 July 2009

A university study – so it must be reliable

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

Example 7

Proud to be Australian

All too often anyone who puts their hand up to be a proud Australian is deemed to be a racist. We are being made to feel like a silent majority in our own country. We true blue Aussies know we have much to be proud of in both our past and present.

D. Wakeman, Tullarmine.
Herald Sun, 24 September 2009

The writer is proud of their National identity

No one wants to be considered racist.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Highlight the inclusive language in the following text:

We should all do our bit to keep our town clean and litter free. It is up to each and every one of us to do our bit and dispose of rubbish thoughtfully.

5. Now write a short paragraph explaining how this inclusive language positions the reader to agree with the point of view.

Example 8

Climate change is a runaway train and having left it so late, there's absolutely nothing we can do to prevent the inevitable destruction it is going to cause.

'Runaway train' makes me think of death and damage – sounds frightening.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. What could be appropriate metaphors for the following:

a. A deadly tsunami: It was a

b. A popular singer: He/she is a

Example 9

Our curiosity is aroused by the reference to something 'fishy' – not quite right – as well as 'fishy' literally referring to seafood.

Fishy frozen seafood rot stinks
Herald Sun, 24 September 2009

This is reinforced because it also 'stinks' – that is, something is 'fishy' in a bad way

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Create three headlines using a pun. This could be for an article on junk food, a sporting event, an incident involving a celebrity or another issue you are familiar with. Remember, puns tend to introduce a note of humour so avoid very serious or tragic topics.

a.

b.

c.

Example 10

**At 60, this grand old dame is in desperate need of a makeover
sentiment alone won't hold the Commonwealth countries together**
by Dhananjavan Sriskandaraiah

.....One of the greatest strengths of the Commonwealth also seems to be one of its greatest weaknesses. The strong historical ties that bind members to each other- and to Britain – are an undeniable part of what makes the Commonwealth work.
.....However, despite the Queen being one of the most powerful symbols of the Commonwealth, monarchy can obscure what the modern Commonwealth represents. The Commonwealth, with 53 countries and 2 billion people, should be the most diverse and Interesting club of nations, not just (a).....vehicle to celebrate Britishness.

The Age, 24 July 2009

The writer respectfully acknowledges the centrality of the Queen –suggests this is not an emotional anti-monarchy

Using 'however' indicates that the writer has considered more than one point of view.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Present both sides of the case for parents advising their children on their future study and/or career choices. Try to make it clear which side of the argument you ultimately favour. Present your case in clear steps, leading your audience to your desired conclusion.

Example 11

This school has been the heart of this community for 45 years.
Can we really be expected to stand back and watch it be taken
away from us without a fight?

The writer presents this question in a way that suggests the answer is an obvious 'no'.

The question makes me feel more involved and that my opinion is important.

1. The main tone of this extract is:

2. The persuasive technique used is:

3. The effect of this persuasive technique on the reader is:

4. Can you think of some other commonly used rhetorical questions? Or some that you have used yourself or heard others use recently? List three examples of rhetorical questions.

a.

b.

c.

This is the conclusion of SECTION 1.

In section 2, you will use the persuasive writing techniques to produce a range of persuasive texts. In section 3, you will explore the editorials, letters to the editor, blogs and opinion pieces, in greater detail.

Students who have not achieved Category 3 OLNA will use OLNA Support WA to develop their reading and writing skills in preparation for Round 1 of OLNA in 2020.

Students who have achieved Category 3 will complete the EST Practise activities in Section 4 of this workbook.

2. Identifying Different Types of Persuasive Texts

Newspapers contain a range of articles and features designed to inform us and shape our opinions. In the majority of newspapers, the most important news stories are reported on the first three pages. The comment or opinion columns, letters to the editor and political cartoons are located with, or very close to, the editorial.

Newspapers, however, are not the only forms used to persuade! Persuasion can be found in blog posts, newsletters, speeches, text messages and advertisements to name just a few. In the next section of this unit, you will:

- Develop your ability to identify different types of persuasive texts
- Deepen your understanding of the features of persuasive texts
- Use argument and persuasive strategies to present your point of view on an issue

Some common persuasive texts and their features are listed in the following table.

Persuasive Text	Features
News report	➤ Informs rather than presents a point of view ➤ Supplies the reader with the most important pieces of information (who, what, when, why, where and how)
Editorial	➤ Expresses the views of the editor or a group of senior journalists about a current issue ➤ Has a publication banner headline that appears at the top of the page ➤ Is sometimes written in a column format ➤ Is generally conservative in language and approach
Feature article	➤ Gives detailed background information about an issue or story ➤ Includes quotes from interviews
Letter to the editor	➤ Is written by a member of the public to express an opinion ➤ Appears on the letters page and is fairly brief ➤ May comment on what others writers have said ➤ Is given a catchy heading by the letters page editor ➤ Uses language that is often more colourful and emotional than that found in an editorial
Opinion piece or news comment	➤ Is usually written by an expert (such as an academic or researcher) or a regular columnist (the writer's name and qualifications are provided at the end of the piece) ➤ Presents an opinion on the issue ➤ Is usually longer than an editorial or letters ➤ Often adopts an authoritative, assertive, confident tone ➤ Often uses formal and sophisticated language
Blog post	➤ Appears online ➤ Length can be short or extended ➤ Often (but not always) uses more informal language

Political cartoon	➤ Is designed to make a political point about a current issue in a different, thought-provoking and amusing way ➤ Is not intended to simply be funny in the same way as the cartoons on the comic's page ➤ Is usually drawn by the newspaper's own political cartoonist; and each cartoonist has a distinctive style
Speech transcript	➤ Is written for a particular audience ➤ Has a clear introduction and greeting ➤ Clearly states a personal viewpoint or contention ➤ Often class the audience to action

Text 1

Boys should Listen to Emma Watson

Emma Watson, a United Nations Women Goodwill Ambassador, addresses the United Nations in New York City



SIR – I watched Emma Watson's UN speech and agreed with everything she said, so I was disappointed by how ignorant some of the other boys in my class were about it (I attend an independent, all-boys school).

We are lucky to live in a western country where women can speak out against stereotypes. Feminism is not about man-hating or female supremacy. It is, by definition, the opposite. It's pretty simple really: if you believe in the social, political and economic equality of the sexes, then you're a feminist.

By using words such as 'girly' we inadvertently buy into gender stereotyping. We play different sports based on gender, and yet it takes some effort for many people to acknowledge the existence of gender inequality and the injustice it entails for both sexes.

If we want equality, it will take more effort than paying women the same as men, or giving women equal opportunities. We must all make an active decision to change our language. We must stop pressuring each other to fit stereotypes which more often than not leaves us feeling repressed and unable to express ourselves. We must not let gender define us.

Ed Holtom (age 15)

St Albans, Hertfordshire

Published in *The Sunday Telegraph*, 28 September 2014

Text 2

Emma Watson speech hardly a game-changer

Clementine Ford



Earlier this week, the internet went slightly mad over a speech by "Emma Watson to the UN General Assembly in New York. A Goodwill Ambassador for UN Women, Watson was there to launch HeForShe, a campaign which calls on men to become advocates for women and 'agents of change' in the fight to end gender inequality.

In her speech, which has been repeatedly labelled 'game-changing', Watson highlighted the impact of gender inequality on boys and men. After providing some very accessible, positive and necessary

thoughts on feminism in general, she offered this observation: ‘We don’t often talk about men being imprisoned by gender stereotypes but I can see that they are, and that when they are free, things will change for women as a natural consequence.’

I’m sorry to be the Grinch who stole Popular Feminism, but this is utter rubbish. Gender inequality comes as a direct result of the enforcement of patriarchal structures. Although men are impacted negatively by it, they are not impacted in the same ways or to the same drastically violent extent as women.

Additionally, men are overwhelmingly the beneficiaries of these patriarchal structures, seeing themselves reflected broadly across society as change-makers and power brokers. Whatever benefits Watson’s speech may have in regard to inspiring a new generation of young feminists (and that is unquestionably an achievement), it is offensive and farcical to suggest that equality and change will come fort women ‘as a natural consequence’ of men being supported to get their feelings in order.

Unfortunately, ideas like this have begun to bubble up in a feminist discourse which seems to have not only adopted a ‘gently, gently’ approach to social and structural change but repositioned the perpetrators of inequality and violence as some kind of vague shadowy cloud and not identifiable groups of people. It’s no longer enough to demonstrate to men the reality of gender oppression through activism and adult dialogue – now we must ‘engage’ them as one would a child, encouraging them to see how behavioural change will also benefit them...

Your turn

Read Texts 1-3 on the following pages. Use the table on the previous page to identify each text: is it speech transcript, political cartoon, blog post, opinion piece or news comment, letter to the editor, feature article, editorial or news report. Once you have identified the type of persuasive text, discuss how the features of this type of text are evident in each example.

Text	Type of text	Features of the text
1		

2		
3		

(T)he unfortunate truth is that gender inequality is about power – who has it, and who wants to retain it. No amount of window dressing (for that is surely what the HeForShe campaign amounts to, given its entire breadth seems to be asking men to click a button and download a twibbon) is going to change the systemic global oppression that results in women’s degradation, subjugation and death in persistently high numbers. And it isn’t, as some have suggested, tearing another woman down’ to want to discuss that reality.

While busy launching flashy guff like HeForShe, the UN has also acknowledged it will fail to meet its Millennium Development Goals (MDG) on gender equality by the target date of 2015, especially its goal on maternal health care and mortality. In the UN Women’s paper on the the MDGs, they admit that limited funding has been devoted to programs which address women’s economic, sexual and social equality...

Across 63 countries around the world, girls are still more likely than boys to be denied access to primary education because of perceptions about girls’ worth. Women do not feature heavily in political leadership, despite evidence suggesting that female-led governance improves policy-making and community benefit. In Australia, one woman is still killed every week by her partner or ex-partner while women’s refuges are being closed down around the country.

These are bit facts that exist because men have thus far been 'denied' entry into feminist debate and activism. They won't disappear 'naturally' when men are empowered to be sensitive. They exist because patriarchal power hinges on the subjugation of women, and anything that distracts from that is a liability to the cause.

I love that Emma Watson has bravely put herself on the line as a proud feminist. It's wonderful that she may be instrumental in inspiring millions more to consider these issues. Bravo to her. But to be truly game-changing, you have to actually change the game. And while it is important for men to choose to be allies, addressing actual systemic inequality through the funding of programs which empower and defend women's sexual, economic and political rights is the only way to ensue women have a chance at winning.

Clementine Ford is a freelance writer

Published in *The Age*, 26 September 2014

Text 3

Emma Watson's feminism: Is it enough?

Whether you're on a university campus or perusing social media, feminism is the current buzz word – especially following Emma Watson's endorsement of the movement as the United Nations Goodwill Ambassador for Women and the spokesperson for the "HeForShe" campaign.

Emma Watson has proven her power, intelligence, and strength, but I felt that her speech did not live up to its surrounding hype. Yes, she took a strong stance for equality and women, and even addressed the fact that equality should work both ways for men and women, but there was a glaring issue for me, which lies clearly both in the concept and title of a 'HeForShe' campaign.

To take a step back, let's address how Watson uses the term 'feminism'. Some find the word aggressive or irrelevant – but for me, her definition is lacking. To quote Watson, 'feminism by definition is the belief that men and women should have equal rights and opportunities'. Whether or not this definition is universally agreed upon, Watson's definition implies an exclusion of others; to label oneself a feminist could be interpreted as excluding the fight for the rights of those who have not achieved equality in our society.

This implied omission is evident in Emma Watson's speech and the 'HeForShe' campaign's application of feminism, which dichotomizes the gender spectrum into 'man' and 'woman'. The problem is that those are not the only gender identities that exist....

Michelle Huang

Student, McGill University

The Huffington Post, 10 July 2014

Your Turn

Write either an editorial, a letter to the editor, an opinion piece, a blog post or a speech expressing your opinion on this issue. When you have finished, annotate your response, highlighting and identifying the features of the type of text you have chosen.

Heading:

[illegible]

[illegible]

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